



August 2026

CONTINUAL
PROFESSIONAL
DEVELOPMENT

Welcome to the latest edition of the FPG monthly round-up newsletter covering everything you need to know including recent industry updates, risk news, mortgage and protection updates and some performance figures.

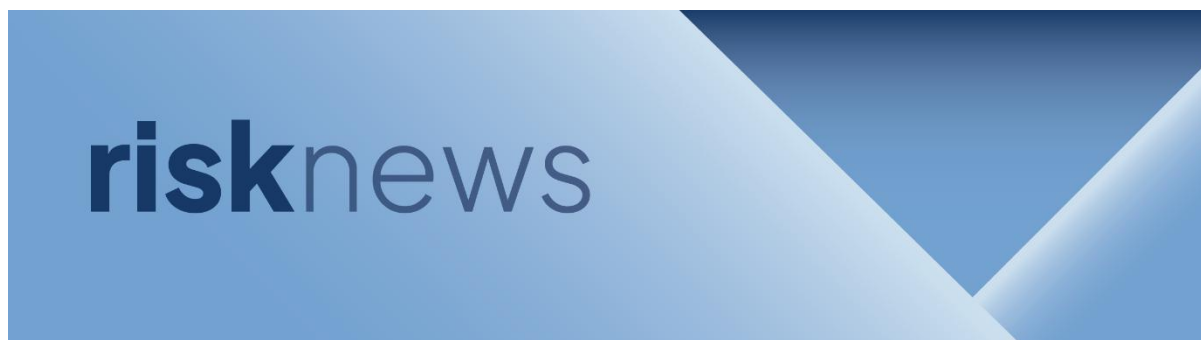
July was our busiest month of the year so far for mortgage completions reflecting a very busy first quarter for new business applications and lots of existing clients needing to be helped. August usually slows down to coincide with the school holidays and if you have got some time off booked over the next few weeks, we hope you enjoy some well earned rest. Let's hope for some rain as well...

Thank you as ever for your continued hard-work and commitment to your clients.

Your FPG team are on hand for anything you need so please get in touch with anything we can help with.

Thank you.

David



Welcome back, Caitlin

Welcome back to Caitlin who has returned from maternity leave, albeit working reduced days until September. Caitlin is likely to be checking your Acre records and helping you clear those flags.

Gifts

Just a reminder that when your lovely clients offer you a gift for the amazing service you've provided, that you need to inform pete.burgess@financeplanning.co.uk so that we can approve the item and record it on our Gifts & Hospitality register.

The same rules and process applies to any gifts or hospitality from our lenders and insurers.

Arranging your own Mortgage or Insurances

If you wish to arrange your own mortgage or protection for yourself on a sole basis, you can either:

- Go direct to the lender (or insurer) and transact the mortgage (or insurance) on an execution only basis as a customer (no proc fee or commission), or
- **Use another adviser** within your Firm to arrange the mortgage (or insurance) on a fully advised basis, or
- **Arrange the mortgage (or insurance) yourself** if this is permitted by the provider (or via another adviser within the Firm). If you wish to limit the documents retained on the

Acre record, you must obtain a concession from the Compliance Team and record this confirmation on Acre.

For joint applications, the mortgage (or insurance) must be arranged by another adviser within the Firm. The other applicant(s) must be contacted directly by that adviser to confirm their agreement to proceed and to provide a brief explanation of the nature of the transaction. This ensures the conflict between adviser and their partner/spouse is appropriately managed.

Unless the sale is fully advised by a colleague, you must sign an Execution Only disclaimer, confirming that you (and any other applicants) have not received advice. This form is available from the Compliance Team.

Record Keeping - ERCs

Just a reminder that where you are providing advice which results in your client incurring Early Repayment Charges on their existing mortgage that the following rules apply

1. This needs to be documented as your advice rather than the clients wishes
2. An explanation in Notes or in the Suitability Letter giving the reason why this route is being taken
3. A calculation in Notes showing the financial loss or financial gain by taking this action.

Record Keeping – Debt Consolidation

We are seeing an increasing number of cases with Debt Consolidation. This is fine providing you believe it is suitable advice and that you are informing the client of all the risk involved.

Sometimes the level of debt is very large, and so please can you ensure that you are always adding a Note to Acre to explain how the client's debts have accumulated. Please also ensure the evidence of the debts is always added to your Acre record too.

Record Keeping – Gifted Deposit

I'm sure we are all aware of our record keeping requirements of Donor ID, Evidence of Funds and a Gift Letter for these cases – but please can you ensure that you have attached these documents to the Acre record before you submit the case for a compliance check.

Where the funds are coming from outside of the UK then please inform the Compliance Team as additional documents may be required.

Record Keeping – Clear Pay payment on bank statements

Where you see many payments to Clear Pay on a client's bank statement it is where they are using a Klarna style process of deferring the payments on their purchases. With Clear Pay you spread the cost of an item over four payments spanning six weeks. Things to note are (i) these do not show as a commitment on a credit report, and (ii) you will need to consider these when completing your budget planner as they do form part of regular monthly outgoings.

Updated Mortgage Advice Standards (MAS)

Attached to this document is our updated Mortgage Advice Standards. This is effectively our rulebook for giving and record mortgage advice. Please ensure you are familiar with its contents.

Recent SARs

In the past 3 months (May to July 2026) we have received 10 new SARs, which is a significant drop in our usual numbers. Please do ensure you are vigilant in trying to detect anything about an individual's situation or paperwork that might require further explanation or clarification. It is important to be challenging your clients, especially when they are presenting more than one income stream. Here is a breakdown of our most recent 10 SARs:

1. Staged Income concerns. 6 instances where the paperwork didn't stack up or where there were concerns with the employment. We agreed to submit a case to the lender in each of these 6 cases.
2. Deposit concerns. Further questioning and explanations from the client meant we agreed to submit this case too.
3. Non-disclosure. Client withheld information from us and the lender and so we cancelled their application.
4. Suspected tax evasion. Client didn't want to disclose their property owned in Nigeria, to pay a lower level of stamp duty, and so we walked away from this one. **
5. Suspected money laundering. Many payments going in and out of a client's bank account. When challenged we were told that it was a Rotating Savings Committee which is common with Nigerians and some church groups. It is where individuals pool their savings each month and take it in turns to buy a property. There is a chance this is just simply money laundering. But if what the client is saying is true then this situation still would not stack up because the client's application would be subjected to (i) affordability based on the repayments (monthly commitments) of those monies borrowed/gifted, and (ii) gift/donor requirements for everyone involved in the syndicate. **

** I'm sure most Nigerian clients are fine, it just so happens that these two were not!

Please do report all your suspicions, even when you have already decided not to transact.



JULY:

After suffering a serious spinal injury in a road traffic accident, one of our clients was told they were unlikely to return to work in their previous profession. While the diagnosis was devastating, there was some welcome relief. Their protection policy included Total & Permanent Disability (TPD) cover, and following a successful claim, they received a lump sum that cleared the outstanding mortgage on their family home. With one less financial worry, they could focus on adapting to a new way of life and supporting their family through an incredibly difficult time. It's a powerful reminder that protection isn't just there for the illnesses we often think about – it can also provide life-changing support when a permanent disability changes everything.

Legal & General – Simpler Online Medical Questionnaires

Legal & General has made it easier for clients to complete their online medical questionnaires. Rather than needing to remember or create login details, clients can now simply follow a secure link sent to them to complete their questions. The change removes a common frustration, particularly for clients who have used L&G previously and can't remember their old login details, helping reduce delays and keep applications moving smoothly.

👉 <https://www.legalandgeneral.com/adviser/protection/>

Vitality – Record £149 Million Paid in Protection Claims

VitalityLife has released its latest claims statistics, paying a record £149 million in protection claims during 2025. The insurer paid 99.4% of life insurance claims, alongside millions in Serious Illness Cover and Income Protection benefits. It's another powerful reminder that protection policies are there to be claimed on, giving advisers real-life evidence to support protection conversations with clients.

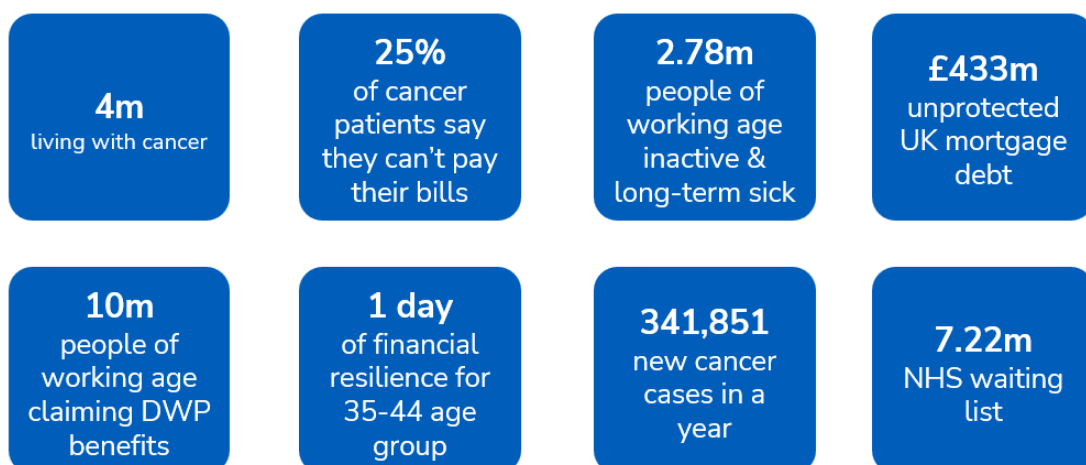
👉 <https://adviser.vitality.co.uk/life-insurance/doing-business/claims/>

The Exeter – HealthWise Added to Income First

The Exeter has enhanced its Income First proposition by including HealthWise, giving members access to services such as remote GP appointments, second medical opinions and mental wellbeing support. It's another example of providers adding everyday value to protection policies, helping advisers demonstrate benefits clients can use long before they ever need to make a claim.

👉 <https://adviser.the-exeter.com/>

Eight doses of reality



These stats show us why income protection is so important.

Income Protection Awareness Week runs from Monday 21st to Friday 25th September, at midday for one hour each day. It is a great way to brush up on your income protection knowledge and skills – whilst gaining 5 hours of CPD!

Click here to register for the webinars. <https://iptf.co.uk/ipaw-2026/>

New Aviva BDM

We have a new Aviva BDM. Dan Hill can be contacted on 07741 681731 or dan.hill@aviva.com

New Met Life BDM

We have a new Met Life BDM. Finnie Patel can be contacted on 01273 876365 or finnie.patel@metlife.com

Protection Guru's – Adviser Ultimate Guide to Protection

Attached is a great guide for Protection Advisers – created by Protection Guru – and can most definitely help in places cases and help us understand more about which insurers have stand-out features on their contracts.



The main theme of the month was lots of re-pricing from several different lenders with very few specific criteria updates.

Family Building Society

This lender has created a new Portal to log into. You should have been contacted by Stuart Heavens to re-register.

Halifax

The threshold for an application to be looked after by their large loans team has been increased to £650,000 from £500,000.

Nationwide

Clients have had the potential to borrow up to 6x income with Nationwide for some time now however they have recently improved the criteria for this with joint applicants now requiring a combined income of £75,000 rather than the previous £100,000.

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)

performance

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for July 2026

Congratulations to **Rob Chart** for topping our mortgage table for last month.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Rob Chart	49
Paul Gent	34
Claire Lipscomb	32
Phil Smith	29
Jack Savory	26
Jim Maye	25
Dan Fletcher	22
Emily Chattaway	21
Joanne Pope	20
Alex Strange	20
Andy Poustie	19
Jonathan Peachey	17
Dipes Rai	16
Cathy Rafferty	16
Dan Grant	15
Unika Rai	15
Jack Humphries	15
Joe Maskell	15
Carl Thorne	14
Paul Ripley	13
Phil James	13
Joe White	13
Trevor Farley	12
Graham Morris	12
Asmita Gurung	12
Smriti Pun	11
Dan Walsh	10
Peter Stickley	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for July 2026

Congratulations to **Rob Chart** for topping the protection table for last month.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Rob Chart	32
Paul Gent	29
Clare Mann	21
Arbin Gurung	20

Jane Hutchinson	16
Carl Thorne	11
Carrie Millin	10
Petru Balan	10
Hannah Logan-Hughes	10
Jack Humphries	10

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables.



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases so far.

Mortgage cases

Oscar Delves	£2,082,198
Oliver Cunningham	£2,025,000
Hannah Logan-Hughes	£1,977,095
Paul Goodey	£1,564,486
Jim Maye	£1,560,101
Rob Chart	£1,419,142
Hannah Logan-Hughes	£1,400,000
Paul Goodey	£1,370,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,300,000
Oliver Cunningham	£1,275,646
Paul Goodey	£1,210,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,196,680
Wilma Scott	£1,158,035
Jim Maye	£1,153,379
Cathy Rafferty	£1,135,868
Tracey Copeland	£1,123,000
Paul Goodey	£1,117,500
Cathy Rafferty	£1,112,151
Tony Hornby	£1,105,899
Paul Goodey	£1,099,999
Jonathan Peachey	£1,085,950
Paul Goodey	£1,066,449
Karen Mills	£1,025,000
Phil Smith	£1,015,000
Rob Chart	£1,007,671

Protection cases

Simon Harris	£1,800,000
Paul Gent	£1,500,000

If you have submitted a policy of £1m or over, or a group of policies to the same client which add up to over £1m, please let me know.

The logo for 'goodnews' is displayed in a dark blue, sans-serif font. The word 'good' is in a bold weight, while 'news' is in a regular weight. The logo is set against a background that is a gradient of light blue and white, with a large orange triangle pointing towards the top right corner.

Race for Life

Well done to Jill Craigs and Tor Maleganeas for getting very muddy and running the race for life in July. So far, they have raised over £700 for Cancer Research UK. If you haven't already donated you can do so here <https://fundraise.cancerresearchuk.org/team/victorias-team-383>.



FPG Anniversaries

A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Chris Williams – 26 years
- Richard Owen – 22 years
- Jill Craigs – 20 years
- Colin Mackay – 19 years
- Graham Morris – 17 years
- Cathy Rafferty – 13 years
- Joanne Pope – 12 years
- Kelly Latter – 8 years
- Jackie Ward – 7 years
- Sophie James – 6 years
- Emily Chattaway – 3 years
- Romi Pal – 2 years
- Laura Turner – 2 years
- Ellie Campbell – 1 year

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list, if you should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in August.

- Chobi Gurung
- Clare Mann
- Mark Ninnim
- Petru Balan
- Richard Owen
- Romi Pal
- Stuart Hunnisett

miscellaneous

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status. We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable, please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

Past Zoom sessions

Here are the details of the Zoom sessions FPG hosted last month and the links to re-watch them. All the below are good for CPD.

06/07/2026 – Exeter and Pete Burgess - <https://knowledgehub.website/6-07-2026-exeter-and-pete/>

13/07/2026 – Allianz & The Tipton - <https://knowledgehub.website/13-07-2026-allianz-the-tipton/>

20/07/2026 – Newcastle - <https://knowledgehub.website/20-07-2026-allianz-the-tipton/>

Future Teams sessions

As you hopefully saw from Matt's emails over the last few weeks our Monday hangout sessions are changing. We are currently in the summer break but from September when they return the sessions will be moving to Wednesdays at 1pm with our first session being 9th September. We will also now be hosting the sessions on Microsoft Teams rather than Zoom. Although we will continue to record the sessions for anybody who can't attend it live. Invites will continue to be sent out in advance so that you know what is coming up. Our first guests on the 9th September will be HSBC and an update from Pete Burgess.